

Is Malta seventh in the EU for cars per person?

A media report of Eurostat figures, tested against the data and its dates

THE CLAIM

“Malta is ranked number seven, just between Germany and Poland ... with 585 cars per 1,000 inhabitants.”

Lovin Malta, 21 September 2024

The outlet's own text, citing a Eurostat dataset “as of 2023”, with a graphic “up to the year 2022”.

The 585 and seventh place are Eurostat's 2022 figures, as revised after January 2024.

VERDICT

MISLEADING

*Right for 2022, but
not Malta's latest rank.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

585

Right for 2022

Eurostat's 2022 figure in today's data: seventh of 27, between Germany and Poland.

12th

Eurostat's 2023 figures

Published by 25 July 2024, two months before the article: Malta about 575.

“is ranked”

Presented as current

Conflicting dates (“as of 2023”, graphic “up to the year 2022”), but seventh in the present tense.

≈602

Revised since

Eurostat's January 2024 release had Malta's 2022 value at about 602, sixth.

14th

Lower since

571 in 2025, below the EU-27's 584: the population grew faster than the car stock.

FAIR TO SAY

The 585 is right for 2022 in Eurostat's current data, and Malta still has by far the most cars per km² of land in the EU (1,014 in 2022; the Netherlands is second at 261).

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Lovin Malta: the data year and Eurostat release it used.

☐ Lovin Malta: the graphic behind the rankings.

☐ NSO: licensed versus garaged and rented cars.